bonus from the Raiders. For two years he draws a six-figure salary to play preseason games, beat up on special teams, and learn the playbook. In his third year he begins to start. Al Davis connects the name with the face, the fans and press talk about his quickness, and opposing players respect his talent. Our man plays three or four more years. During that period his salary doubles and then doubles again. He also makes big money on promotions and endorsements. But the travel, late nights, long workouts, mental strain, and injuries slow him by a fraction of a second. He begins to dread that inevitable Sunday when a younger player starts in his place. A season later he's washed up, as useless as a water boy without a pail.

But our man hired an agent to help him make deals, invest, and prepare for retirement. When his playing career ends he can live the rest of his life on interest and dividends from his investments. He may choose to buy a car dealership or open a saloon. But he may also choose to travel, relax on the beach, or organize a Special Olympics for retarded children.

We executives probably think we're smarter than the average jock. Most of us handle our own investments. But who's to tell *us* when to retire? Should we retire in our early 30s, like Sandy Koufax? In our 40s, like Pete Rose? Or in our 60s, like our fathers, grandfathers, and great-grandfathers? If a washed-up Raider can't decide to retire, Al Davis decides for him. Do you want your company to decide for you? Or do you want to step down on your own with dignity, when you're still young and clearly in command?

This book is the first attempt to do for executives, screenwriters, models, stock jockeys, whiz kids, and mad marketeers what agents like Irving Marks do for highly paid jocks. Start thinking like athletes and you may wind up retiring at the same age they do. And you've got a big advantage. Their legs are shot. You can go back to work if you feel like it.